Azure for Students — Step-by-Step Signup Guide

This guide walks you through creating a Microsoft account, verifying your student status, activating the $100 Azure credits, and confirming the subscription.

https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/education-hub/about-azure-for-students

1) Before You Start (Checklist)

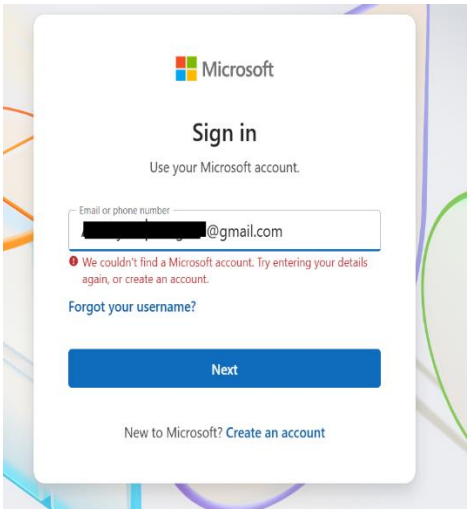
- Prepare the following: - Active **college/university email ID** (e.g., `.edu`, `.ac.in`, `.edu.in`)
- Mobile phone number (for OTP verification)
- Student ID card (only needed if manual verification is requested) - Stable internet connection

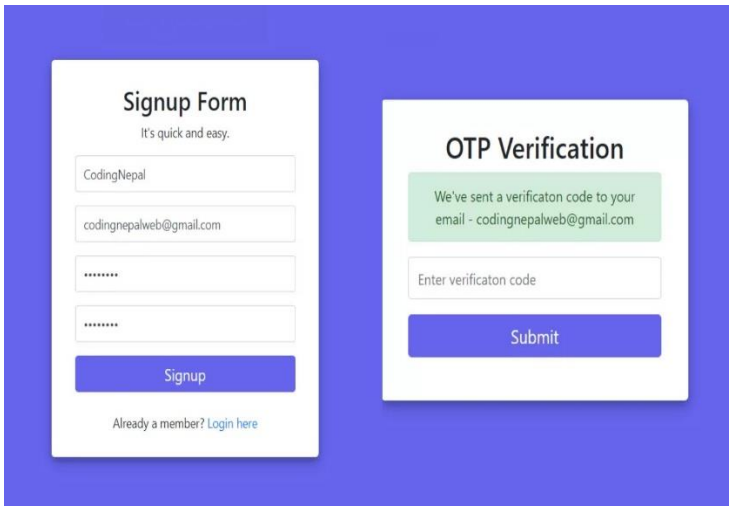
Personal email (Gmail, Yahoo, etc.) cannot be used for the student offer.

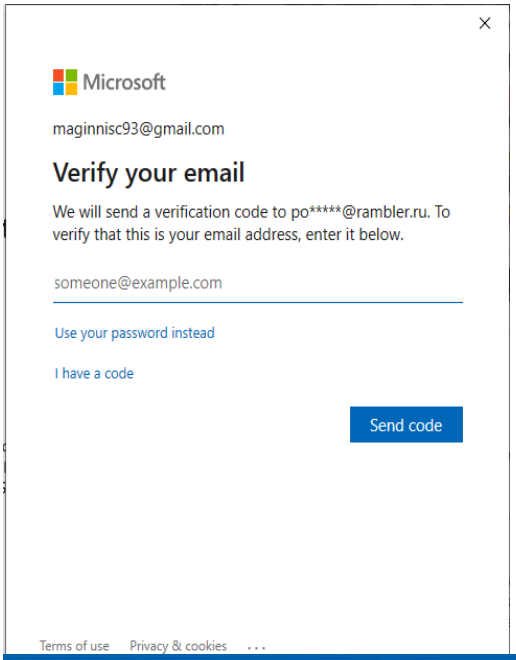
2) Create a Microsoft Account (Using Your Student Email)

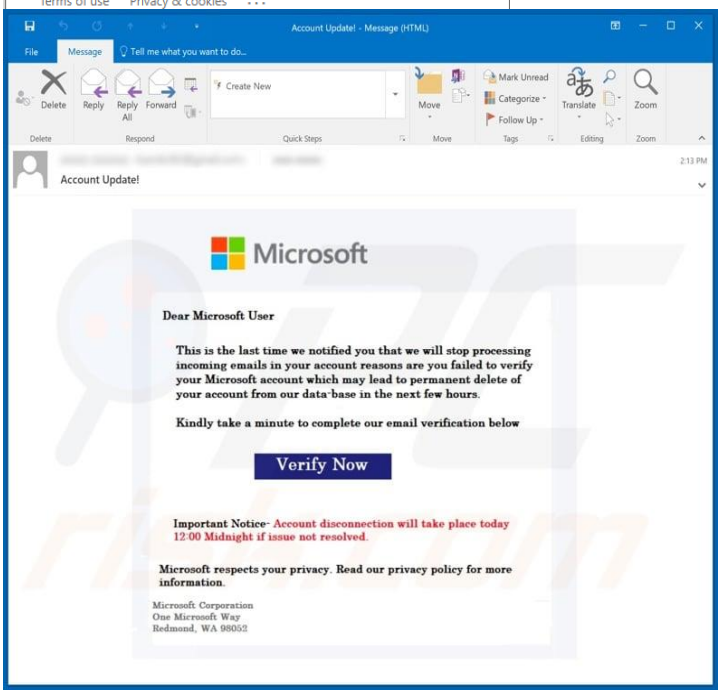
1. Go to: https://signup.live.com
2. Click **Use your email instead**
3. Enter your *college email address*
4. Create a strong password
5. Verify the OTP sent to your email

You now have a Microsoft account linked to your student email.









3) Open the Azure for Students Page

1. Visit: https://azure.microsoft.com/en-in/free/students/
2. Click **Start free**
3. Sign in with the Microsoft account you just created

Azure for Students

- Available only to full-time university students*
- No credit card required
- Free monthly amounts of 20+ popular services for 12 months (new Azure customers only)
- Free monthly amounts of 65+ always-free services
- Access to full catalog of services up to free amounts and USD 100 credit
- Gain access to industry-leading technology like Azure OpenAI along with extensive resources curated for student developers to accelerate your learning
- Engage in interactive exploration and immediate real-world application in development, data science, and cloud computing – at any level
- Renew your subscription annually and continue to get free access to Azure as long as you're a student

$ 100 credit

to use on Azure services within 12 months

Sign up

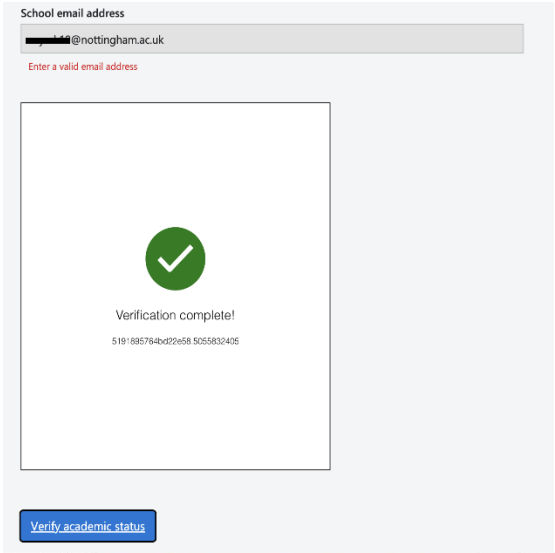
4) Verify Student Status

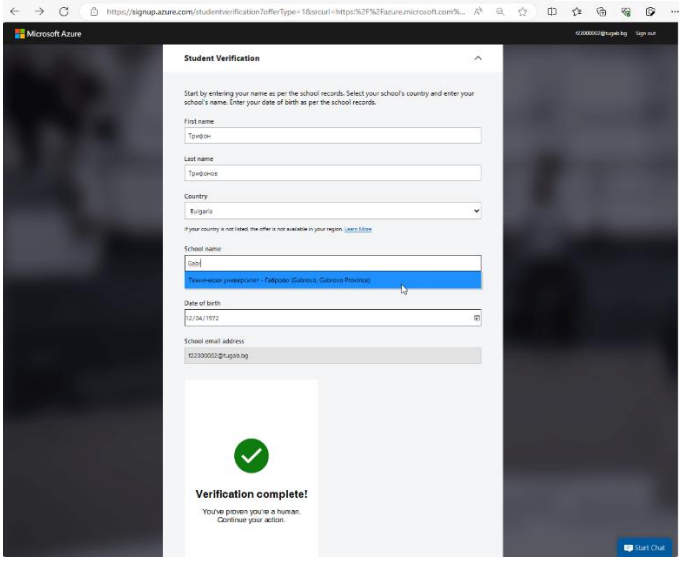
Azure will ask you to confirm that you are a student.

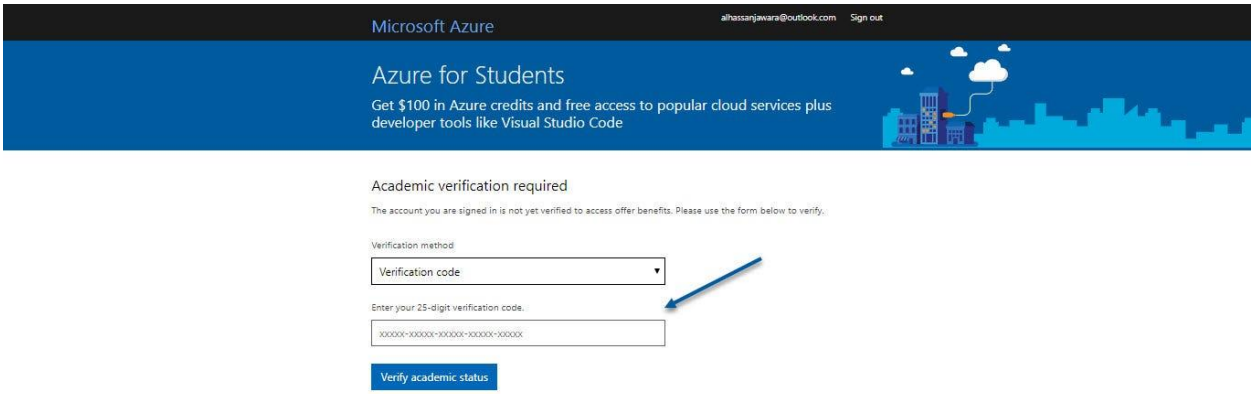
Automatic verification (most colleges)

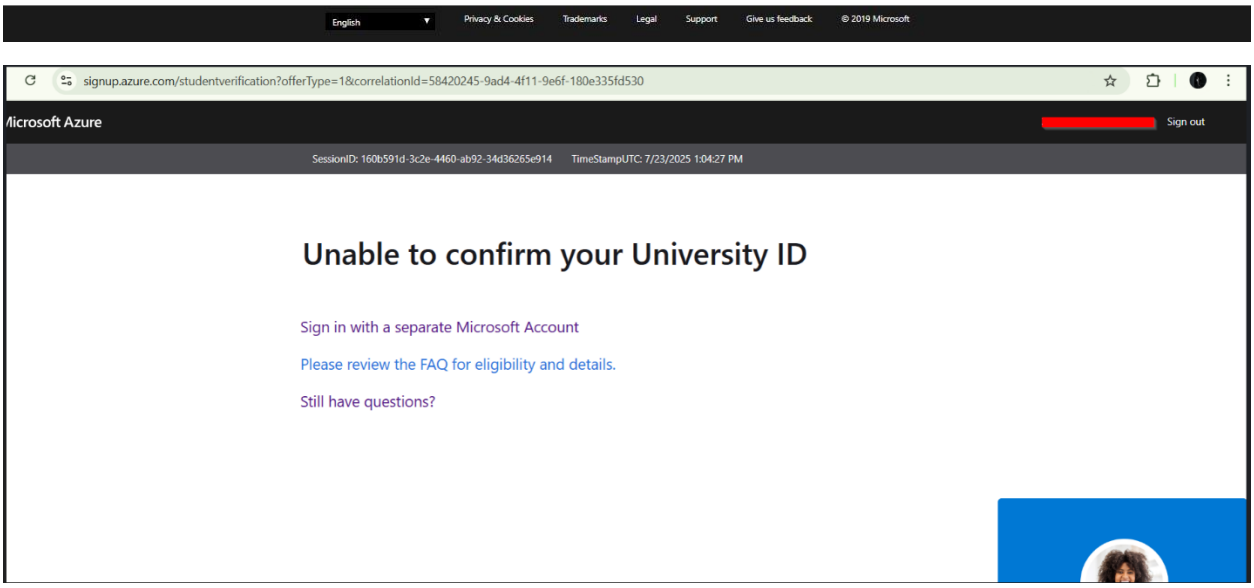
1. Re-enter your student email
2. Receive verification code
3. Enter OTP

You will be instantly verified if your college domain is recognized.


School email address
[redacted]@nottingham.ac.uk
Enter a valid email address
Verification complete!
519!885784bd22e58.5055832405
Verify academic status


Microsoft Azure
Sign out
Student Verification
Start by entering your name as per the school records. Select your school's country and enter your school's name. Enter your date of birth as per the school records.
First name
Last name
Country
Bulgaria
If your country is not listed, the offer is not available in your region. Learn More
School name
Date of birth
12/04/1972
School email address
Verification complete!
You've proven you're a human.
Continue your action.
Start Chat





Manual verification (if required)

Upload one of the following: - Student ID card - Bonafide certificate - Fee receipt

Approval time: typically, 5–30 minutes (sometimes a few hours).

5) Phone Number Verification

1. Enter your mobile number
2. Receive SMS OTP
3. Enter OTP to confirm

No credit card is required for Azure for Students.

Cancel

Phone number

XXX-XXX-50977

Change

Continue

Agreement

Identity verification by phone

A text or phone call helps us make sure this is you.

Country code

Ukraine (+380)

Phone number

9844 50000

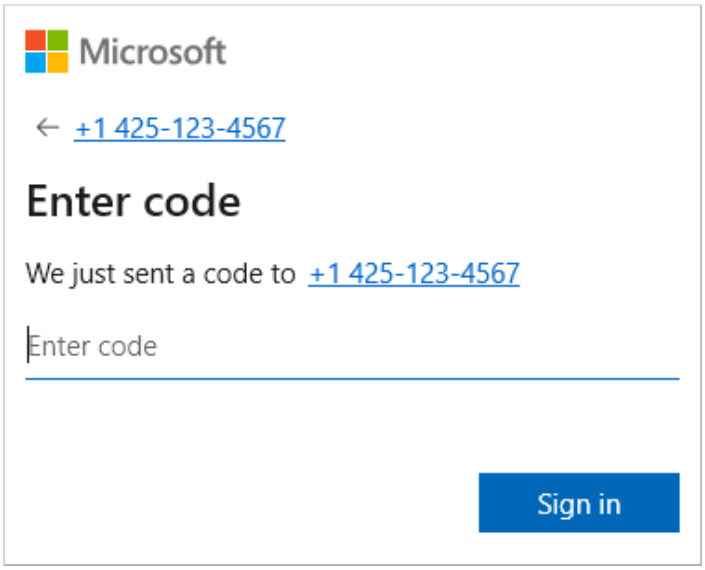
Please do not enter country code in your phone number.

Text me

Call me

Identity verification by card

Sign up

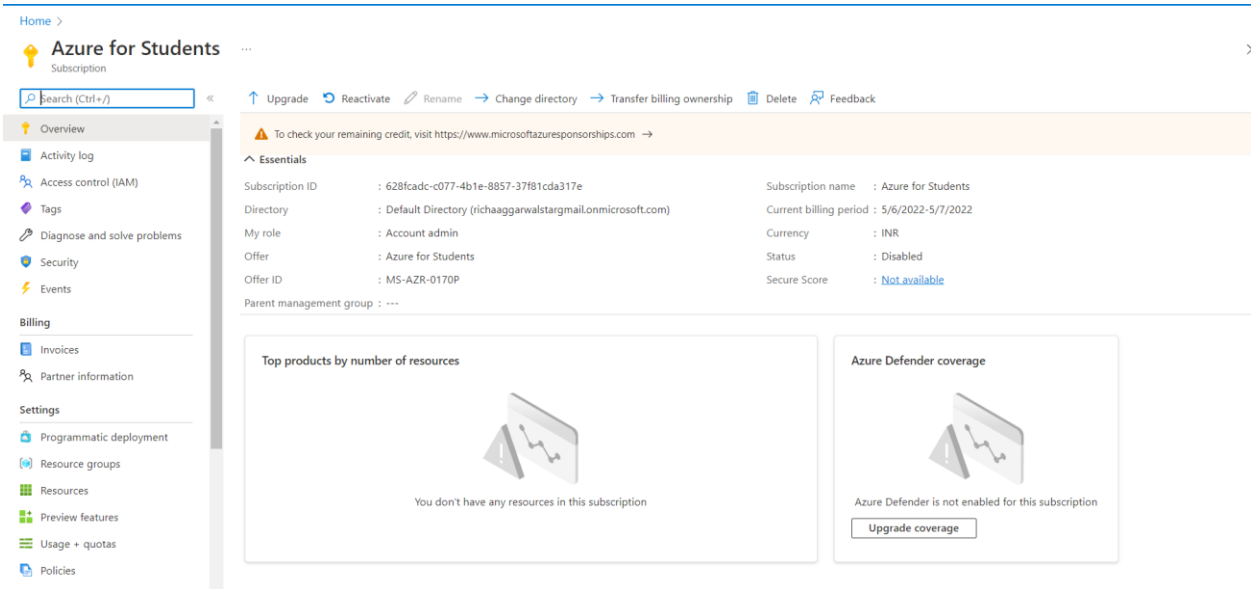


6) Activate the Subscription

1. Accept the subscription agreement
2. Click **Activate**
3. Wait 1–3 minutes for setup

After activation, the Azure portal will open automatically.

You now receive: - $100 Azure credits (valid 12 months) - Access to always-free services



*Right after activation, create a **budget alert** — many students accidentally run a large virtual machine, and the $100 disappears in 2 days.*

7) Confirm Your Credits

1. Go to: https://portal.azure.com
2. Search **Subscriptions**
3. Open **Azure for Students**

To check credit balance: 1. Search **Cost Management + Billing** 2. Click **Credits** 3. View remaining balance

8) Recommended Safety Step (Prevent Credit Loss)

Create a budget alert: 1. Cost Management → Budgets → Add 2. Amount: $90 3. Alert threshold: 80%

This prevents accidental usage of all credits.

9) Common Problems & Fixes

Not eligible

Possible causes: - Non-student email - Expired college email - Already used Azure free trial before

Fix: Create a new Microsoft account using your student email and retry.

No verification email received

- Check spam folder
- Wait 10 minutes and resend

Credits show $0

You may be viewing the wrong subscription. Go to: Portal → Subscriptions → Azure for Students → Cost Management.

Tip: Start with small resources (B1s VM or free App Service) to avoid fast credit consumption.